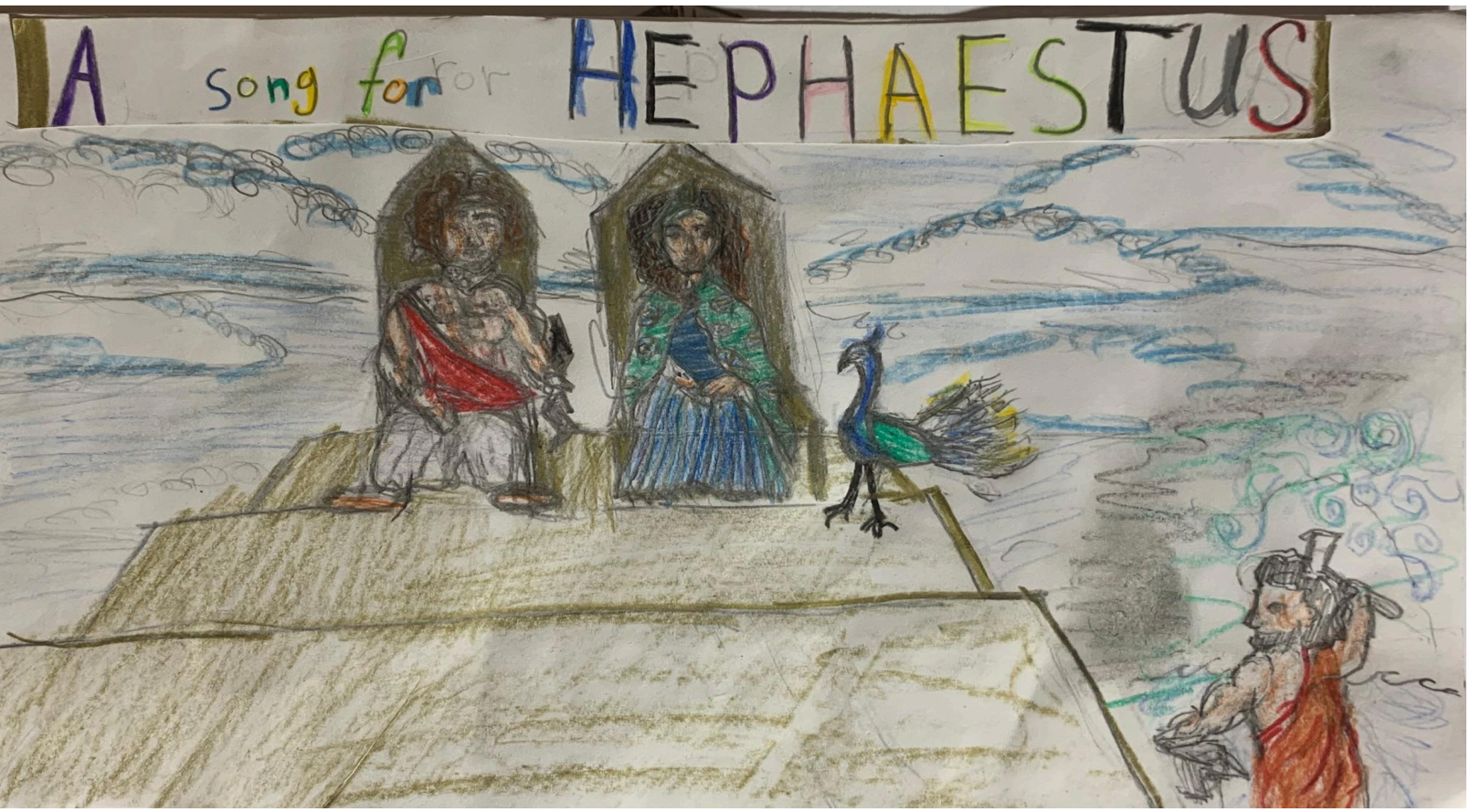
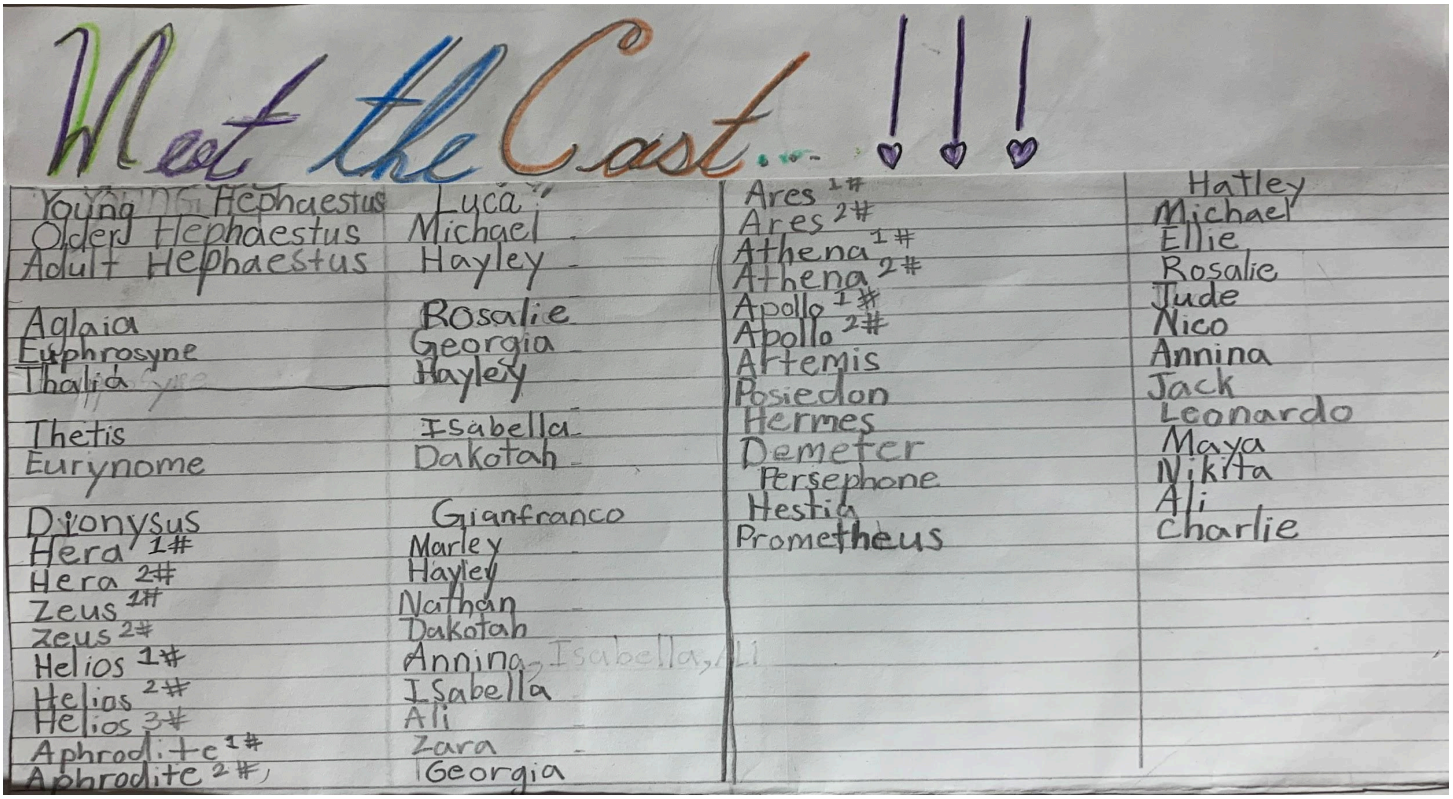
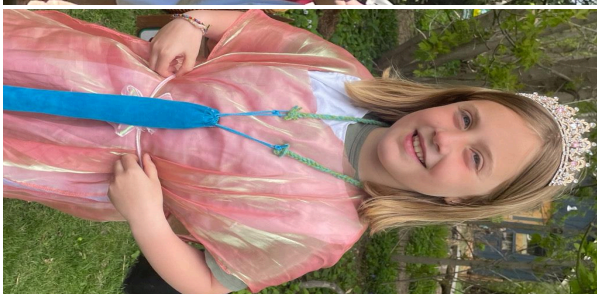

A song for HEPHAESTUS


Meet the Cast...!!!
Young Hephaestus
Older Hephaestus
Adult Hephaestus
Aglaia
Euphrosyne
Thalia
Thetis
Eurynome
Dionysus
Hera 1#
Hera 2#
Zeus 1#
Zeus 2#
Helios 1#
Helios 2#
Helios 3#
Aphrodite 1#
Aphrodite 2#
Luca
Michael
Hayley
Rosalie
Georgia
Hayley
Isabella
Dakotah
Gianfranco
Marley
Hayley
Nathan
Dakotah
Annina, Isabella, Ali
Isabella
Ali
Zara
Georgia
Ares 1#
Ares 2#
Athena 1#
Athena 2#
Apollo 1#
Apollo 2#
Artemis
Posiedon
Hermes
Demeter
Persephone
Hestia
Prometheus
Hatley
Michael
Ellie
Rosalie
Jude
Nico
Annina
Jack
Leonardo
Maya
Nikita
Ali
Charlie







A list Of Songs...

1. Glorious Apollo
2. Ever Restless
3. Cast Aside
4. Hephaestus Steals into the night
5. Gifts to the goddesses
6. Silver lining
7. Pretty Things
8. Where life is easy
9. Im your night mare
10. over the mountain
11. Ever restless Recapot last verse # in harmony

A SONG FOR HEPHAESTUS

A Forged in Fable Theatre Production

Script and Libretto

A SONG FOR HEPHAESTUS

ADAPTED FOR CHILDREN: ACT ONE

Book by
Robin Moir

Music by
Robin Moir with Liam Britten

Lyrics by
Robin Moir



















Hephaestus is the Greek god of artisans and sculptors who was cast out of Mount Olympus at birth for reasons he cannot control. Although he was raised by two Sea Nymphs who love him, the trauma of being deserted and shunned by his mother turns into a quest for revenge. Hephaestus sends a beautiful throne to Olympus and succeeds in entrapping his mother in it. He will not release her despite Aphrodite's promise to marry him; Athena's vow to give him prestige and a studio on the mountain; and Ares' threats of war and destruction. It is only when Dionysus talks to him as an equal that Hephaestus is receptive to the opportunity and risk of facing Hera again while beginning the journey towards forgiveness and healing. Dionysus' role is significant as the narrator and character whose genuine conversation finds common ground and allows for forward motion. Hephaestus' ability to listen and be open allows the two to find a solution that makes life better for everyone; where Hephaestus is able to return home to Mount Olympus. Ultimately this is a story about finding value and beauty in our differences, letting go of resentment, pain, and control, and learning to build connections to live and create authentically. It is a story for people of all ages about self-discovery, acceptance, and the healing power of Art.

CHARACTERS

HEPHAESTUS - The god of the forge and the child of Hera who was cast out of Olympus at birth and raised by the Oceanids Thetis and Eurynome.

YOUNG HEPHAESTUS #1 (Luca)
OLDER HEPHAESTUS #2 (Michael)
ADULT HEPHAESTUS #3 (Hayley)

THE CHARITES - Three daughters of Zeus & Eurynome who bring festivity, pleasure, song, dance, friendship, and community wherever they go:

AGLAIA - The goddess of radiance, good health, and brilliance. **(Rosalie)**

EUPHROSYNE - The goddess of good cheer, merriment, joy, and mirth **(Georgia)**

THALIA - The goddess of abundance, blooming flowers, festivities, and banquets **(Hayley)**

THE OCEANIDS:

THETIS - One of the sea nymphs who raises Hephaestus **(Isabella)**

EURYNOME - One of the sea nymphs who raises Hephaestus, mother of the Charities **(Dakotah)**

THE OLYMPIANS:

DIONYSUS - The god of wine and theatre **(Gianfranco)**

HERA #1 & HERA #2 - The mother of Hephaestus and wife to Zeus, queen mother of the Olympians **(Marley & Hayley)**

ZEUS #1 & ZEUS #2 - The God of the Sky, Thunder, and Lightning, husband of Hera, ruler of Olympus **(Nathan & Dakotah)**

HELIOS - The Sun God **(Anina, Isabella & Ali)**

APHRODITE #1 & APHRODITE #2 - The Goddess of Desire, Love, and Beauty, Hephaestus's first wife **(Zara & Georgia)**

ARES #1 & ARES #2 - The God of War **(Hatley & Michael)**

ATHENA #1 & ATHENA #2 – Daughter of Zeus, the Goddess of Wisdom **(Ellie & Rosalie)**

APOLLO #1 & APOLLO #2 – Son of Zeus, God of Archery, Healing, Music and Light, twin of Artemis **(Jude & Nico)**

ARTEMIS – Daughter of Zeus, the Goddess of the Hunt, Nature and Wild Animals, twin sister of Apollo **(Anina)**

POSEIDON – Brother of Zeus, the God of the Sea, restless and moody **(Jack)**

HERMES – Zeus's son, the Herald of the Gods, wears a cap with wings and winged sandals **(Leonardo)**

DEMETER – Zeus's sister, the Goddess of the Harvest **(Maya)**

HESTIA

BACK TO A WORLD WHERE THEY DANCE

(Hestia offers her throne to Hephaestus and he thanks her and then sits. She goes centre stage and sits cross-legged)

COMPANY

IN THE LIGHT UP ABOVE!
LIGHT UP ABOVE
LIGHT UP ABOVE

(All take their places for the curtain call bow)

#2 - Ever Restless: RECAP of last verse in Harmony

COMPANY

HEPHAESTUS, EVER RESTLESS, SINCE YOU DROPPED LIKE A STONE
FROM THE HEAVENS INTO MY ARMS, ON THE SHORES I USED TO COMB
HOW I HAVE AND DO AND WILL FOREVER LOVE YOU AS MY OWN
YES, I'VE LOVED AND LOVE AND WILL FOREVER LOVE YOU AS MY OWN

SCENE 7

A TRAIL UP THE SIDE OF MOUNT OLYMPUS

#10 Over the Mountain

COMPANY

OVER THE MOUNTAIN AND UP THROUGH THE STORM
BACK TO A LAND WHERE YOUR DREAMS WILL BE FORMED

HEPHAESTUS

LEAVE BEHIND ECHOES OF THE LIFE I HAVE KNOWN
BACK TO A WORLD THAT I NEVER THOUGHT I COULD CALL HOME, HOME

(They say their goodbyes to THETIS and EURYNOME and THE THREE CHARITES)

THETIS, EURYNOME & THE THREE CHARITES

OVER THE MOUNTAIN AND BACK TOWARD THE SKIES
I SEE THE FEAR AND THE HOPE IN YOUR EYES

THETIS, EURYNOME & THE THREE CHARITES, HEPHAESTUS & DIONYSUS

LEAVE BEHIND ECHOES OF A LIFE THAT WON'T BE
BACK TO A WORLD WHERE YOU YEARN TO BE FREE

(Dionysus and Hephaestus ascend the mountain and greet the gods)

OLYMPIANS & COMPANY

SWEET OLYMPUS, YOU ARE BRIGHT AND YOU ARE FAIR
I AM YOURS AND YOU ARE MINE, BASK IN THE GLOW WITHOUT A CARE
I AM ALL-POWERFUL AND ONLY THE MOST BEAUTIFUL AND BLESSED
BELONG TO YOU HERE

HEPHAESTUS

OVER THE MOUNTAIN, IN THE EYE OF THE STORM
WILL ALL BE LOST – DOOMED SINCE THE DAY I WAS BORN?

THETIS, EURYNOME & THE THREE CHARITES

FOLLOW THE ECHOES OF NEW LIFE AND NEW LOVE

HESTIA – Eldest sister of Zeus, Goddess of the Hearth, gentlest of all the Olympians, she gives up her throne and sits by the hearth so Hephaestus has a throne **(Ali)**

PERSEPHONE – Daughter of Demeter, personification of spring, and queen of the underworld **(Nikita)**

PROMETHEUS – Titan who steals fire from Hephaestus' workshop to give to humanity **(Charlie)**

TIME: Prehistory **PLACE:** Greece: the oceans, volcanic caves, and Mount Olympus

ACT I

SCENE 1

OLYMPUS AND THE OCEANS BELOW
#1 Glorious Apollo -- Recorder and then Sing

(*Apollo enters centre stage in a flourish with the Three Charites. All face the mountain)*

(Zeus appears on top of the mountain. All raise their hands)

ALL *(Recite the Ode to Zeus)*
To you all honour O Olympia
Guided by the wisdom of Zeus,
Grant that my skills reap triumph.
For my limbs I ask grace and beauty
For my heart, courage and honesty
Know, my all-powerful Zeus
That my efforts will never falter.

(Both Apollo and Dionysus walk towards centre stage, each carrying a large scroll. Both are surprised to see each other. Apollo throws Dionysus's sunglasses aside. Apollo opens his scroll and begins to read)

APOLLO #2
Once upon a mountain peak, there lived a lusty god named Zeus

(Zeus #1 stands on top of the mountain with hands on hips proudly)

DIONYSUS
His greatest fear was looking weak, his favourite hobby, to reproduce

(Hera #1 appears on the mountain and sits beside Zeus)

APOLLO #2
He married the beautiful Hera, the goddess of mothers and wives

*(*DIONYSUS *and* HEPHAESTUS *speak to each other)*

DIONYSUS
You know, she wasn't lying, Aphrodite's looking for a spouse
And Olympus has a mighty forge, you wouldn't have to sit around playing house

And I'll tell you again – you've got the upper hand, my friend
You're a god too. What do *you* want in the end?

Do you want to have another drink?
Do you want to stay here and moan?
Or… I could grab my donkey
And I could take you home

HEPHAESTUS
I don't need another drink.
There's no need to cry or moan
Maybe it's time for a change,
But I don't know that I could ever call that mountain home…

SCENE 6

HEPHAESTUS' WORKSHOP - UNDERWATER VOLCANIC CAVE

HEPHAESTUS keeps working, his hammering echoes and builds, creating a rhythmic cacophony. DIONYSUS enters and eventually makes his way to Hephaestus and gestures him over for a drink and chat. HEPHAESTUS continues working, at first.

DIONYSUS
Hey Hephaestus, how've you been?
Haven't seen such a stir since when
Your mother chained ol' Zeus to his bed
So good job, but be careful how you tread

HEPHAESTUS
I HAVE NO MOTHER…

DIONYSUS
Well, that's just not quite true
But why don't you think about the things she can do for you?

HEPHAESTUS
I HAVE NO MOTHER; I HAVE NO LIFE!
ALL I HAVE IS THIS HIDING PLACE TO SHARPEN MY KNIFE!

DIONYSUS
You've already performed a prodigious retribution
Between us, I was tickled by your bold execution
And everybody's laughed at her – you made her miniscule
Don't tell Hera, but she'll never quite live down such shameful ridicule

HEPHAESTUS
You know, some other gods were here -

DIONYSUS
Come here and tell me what they said

DIONYSUS
Who didn't much enjoy being either - but we don't all get to choose our lives

APOLLO #2
They made a shining, glorious home that all the earth could covet

DIONYSUS
And Zeus forgot about his vows, as if he were above it!

(*Dionysus throws Apollo's scroll aside and waves him off stage. Apollo reluctantly leaves. The Olympians go to their mountain places)*

(DIONYSUS)
Old Zeus once loved a cunning Titan, but he soon swallowed her up whole
Jealous of omens about their child, his absolute power took a toll

One day old Zeus got such a headache that all else disappeared
He tried everything that came to mind and yet it never cleared
And so young Ares, God of War suggested something new

ARES #1
What better way to stop a splitting ache than to split your skull in two?

DIONYSUS *Zeus said -*

ZEUS #1 Sure, I'll try anything to dull this agony

DIONYSUS
But when the sword came down no one expected what they'd see
For Zeus's little unborn child had grown into a god
But gotten stuck in Zeus's head and fought and screamed and clawed

Until she finally was released by Ares's swift and mighty blow
And so, Athena, the wise, was born in a bright and dazzling show

But Hera didn't know about that long past love affair
And thought it all a flagrant display of ego and of flair

And so, she took it on to make a child by herself
To show she was his equal who deserved respect and wealth
And so, the babe Hephaestus came to the world from Hera alone
But when she looked upon him, she was chilled to her very bone

HERA #1
I don't find him beautiful! I don't find him charming or strong
Just look, he's flawed and lacking - and his legs are bent and wrong!

DIONYSUS
And so, she threw her little child from off the highest peak
She hoped that that would be the end -

HERA #1
Of this I'll never speak!

DIONYSUS
Hephaestus fell for many nights and landed in the seas
And there two sea nymphs picked him up and set his heart at ease
The sea nymphs, Thetis and Eurynome decided then and there
That they would help Hephaestus and give him all their love and care

THETIS
We'll raise you as our very own but keep you hid away
Within volcanic ocean caves you'll grow and work and play

EURYNOME
Because we know the fury of the gods is swift and bleak
And if the gods want you gone, they'll kill you or they'll wreak
Havoc on all that you hold dear and destroy your hopes and dreams

THETIS
And so, you'll grow up between love and fear - and wild, elemental extremes

DIONYSUS
But Hephaestus had great spirit

I mean, and hear me out – what if, instead of seduction, bribery, and threats
You just let me try to talk to him as equals, before we all do something we regret

SCENE 5

MOUNT OLYMPUS

ARES #1
That Hephaestus has got it coming!
He won't listen! He won't see!

APHRODITE #1
I mean, can you imagine,
What's wrong with him to turn down me?

POSEIDON
Let's destroy him! Let's diminish him!

APHRODITE #1
Till there's nothing left at all!

POSEIDON
It's time for that Hephaestus to take another fall!

ZEUS #1
Ready yourselves for battle!
Fall in line, we'll make him see!

OLYMPIANS (EXCEPT DIONYSUS)
It's time to ready ourselves for battle!

ZEUS #1
For only with his ending will we ever find the key!

APOLLO
Well, hey now fellows, isn't this just a bit extreme?
I mean, we hardly even know this guy…

DIONYSUS
– and nothing's ever as it seems…

And Hephaestus had great heart
He fought every day against his fate
To make his life a work of art

(*Exit DIONYSUS*)

SCENE 2

HEPHAESTUS' UNDERWATER VOLCANIC CAVE

(The set settles around THETIS and EURYNOME. They sing to the swaddled baby Hephaestus)

#2 - Ever Restless

EURYNOME, THETIS, and COMPANY

HEPHAESTUS, EVER RESTLESS, SINCE YOU DROPPED LIKE A STONE
FROM THE HEAVENS INTO MY ARMS, ON THE SHORES I USED TO COMB
HOW I HAVE AND DO AND WILL FOREVER LOVE YOU AS MY OWN
YES, I'VE LOVED AND LOVE AND WILL FOREVER LOVE YOU AS MY OWN

HEPHAESTUS, EVER RESTLESS, SINCE YOU SHOT LIKE A STAR
FROM THE TOP OF THE HIGHEST PEAKS, TWISTING THROUGH THE CLOUDS SO FAR
TO MAKE YOUR LITTLE CRADLE AMONGST BRACKISH, FORMLESS FOAM
YOU HAVE MADE OUR STONY LONESOME HOVEL TURN INTO A HOME

(*YOUNG HEPHAESTUS enters and moves to his forge. He begins working, silent and sullen.*)

THETIS

AND HOW I TRY TO MAKE YOU SEE AND HOW I TRY TO TALK YOU THROUGH
WHILE YOU'RE HAMMERING AWAY, LOST IN SORROW, LOST IN SORROW
WHILE YOU'RE HAMMERING AWAY LOST IN SORROW AS YOU
MOULD THE EARTH AROUND YOU, TIL IT GLEAMS LIKE GOLDEN SUN
YOU ALMOST MAKE ME FORGET WE HIDE IN SHADOW, HIDE IN SHADOW
…ALMOST MAKE ME FORGET, AND YET YOUR WORK IS NEVER DONE

EURYNOME

SO EASY TO SEE YOUR BEAUTY – YOUR STRENGTH AND LOVE SHINE THROUGH
SO DIFFICULT TO COMPREHEND, THAT SHE COULDN'T SEE YOU
AND I KNOW YOUR HEART IS BROKEN, AND IT'S NOT MY HEART TO MEND
WHAT IS LIFE WITHOUT YOUR FREEDOM? WHAT IS LIFE WITHOUT A FRIEND?

EURYNOME, THETIS, and COMPANY (Harmony)

HEPHAESTUS, EVER RESTLESS, SINCE YOU DROPPED LIKE A STONE

ARES #2

YOU'LL BE SORRY, MARK MY WORDS – YOU'VE MADE A GRAVE MISTAKE!
I'LL GIVE YOU TIME TO RECONSIDER…
BUT…IF I RETURN WITHOUT YOUR FULL COOPERATION – YOUR FEEBLE BODY I WILL BREAK!

(ARES exits to the thundering of war drums.)

(ATHENA exits and the cave returns to its original look. HEPHAESTUS gets back to work. Battle sounds, clashing swords, war drums fill the air. ARES enters aggressively and moves towards HEPHAESTUS, standing over him, trying to elicit a fight. HEPHAESTUS doesn't engage or shrink but listens silently.)

DIONYSUS
When bribery didn't quite pan out, it was the final straw,
So, Hera called Ares, God of War, to lay down the law

#9 I'm Your Nightmare

ARES #1
YOU HAD BETTER LISTEN WELL, AND YOU HAD BETTER LISTEN CLEAR

ARES #2
I COULD KILL YOU AS SOON AS LOOK AT YOU
YOU SHOULD BE QUIVERING WITH FEAR
YOU SHOULD BE COWERING IN THE CORNER
DO YOU KNOW WHO IT IS I AM?
I'M YOUR NIGHTMARE, I'M YOUR LACK OF PEACE!
WITH ME AGAINST YOU, YOU'D SURELY BE DAMNED!

OH DEAR, DID I FORGET TO MENTION WHY I'M HERE?
HOW QUEER - IT SEEMED TO SLIP MY MIND, I FEAR!

RELEASE YOUR MOTHER, HERA, FROM HER SHACKLED, FETTERED THRONE
UNLESS YOU'D LIKE TO END THIS LIFE AND DIE AN UGLY DEATH ALONE

HEPHAESTUS #3
I HAVE NO MOTHER. I HAVE NO LIFE.
ALL I HAVE IS THIS HIDING PLACE TO SHARPEN MY KNIFE
I HAVE NO PRETENCE I HAVE NO FEAR
FOR I HAVE NOTHING LEFT TO LOSE

(HEPHAESTUS stops listening to ARES and goes back to work at his forge.)

FROM THE HEAVENS INTO MY ARMS, ON THE SHORES I USED TO COMB
HOW I HAVE AND DO AND WILL FOREVER LOVE YOU AS MY OWN
YES, I'VE LOVED AND LOVE AND WILL FOREVER LOVE YOU AS MY OWN

#3 Cast Aside

YOUNG HEPHAESTUS #1 (COMPANY)
WHEN YOU CAST ME ASIDE
I FELL FAR, I BRUISED MY PRIDE
HOW I SANK AND HOW I CRIED
WHEN YOU LET ME GO

COMPANY
STILL, YOU JUST TURNED AWAY
INTO THE LIGHT, HAD A LOVELY DAY
YOU DIDN'T CARE ABOUT THE SEAS OF GREY
THAT CRASHED AND BANGED BELOW

YOUNG HEPHAESTUS #1
BUT THOSE SEAS WERE MY NEW HOME

DIONYSUS
And so, his heartbreak turned to rage
His happy home turned to a cage

Some folks run away by drinking red wine
Some by flirting or eating or chasing false signs

Hephaestus ran away into his work
He never stopped, he never shirked

His pain hardened him over
Like the scars from his fall

Forged in great darkness
He built up his walls

(*YOUNG HEPHAESTUS #1 goes out of view into the shadows. OLDER HEPHAESTUS #2 Enters)*

OLDER HEPHAESTUS #2
I HAVE NO MOTHER, I HAVE NO LIFE
JUST THIS HIDING PLACE TO SHARPEN MY KNIFE
I HAVE NO PRETENCE, I HAVE NO FEAR
FOR I HAVE NOTHING LEFT TO LOSE

COMPANY
STILL, I DON'T KNOW HOW YOU JUST WALKED AWAY
INTO THE LIGHT, HAD A LOVELY DAY
YOU DIDN'T CARE ABOUT THE FIRE AT PLAY
THAT RAGED AND SPAT BELOW

OLDER HEPHAESTUS #2
BUT THAT FIRE WAS MY NEW HOME

(OLDER HEPHAESTUS #2 Exits and ADULT HEPHAESTUS #3 Enters fully grown, continuing to work)

DIONYSUS
The beauty and strength he thought he didn't deserve,
He put into art, and he learned how to serve

He put all of that pain and all that desire
Into objects that could last through time and through fire

And one day his rage grew a taste for vengeance
And he couldn't quite shake wanting to get the chance

To make his dear mother understand
How it feels to be trapped and silenced and damned

To a life that you never wanted or sought
To a problem whose answer couldn't be bought

#8 Where Life is Easy

ATHENA #1 (On the mountain)
I COME FROM A LAND WHERE LIFE IS EASY
WHERE ONLY THE MOST MIGHTY AND DESERVING DWELL
WHERE YOUR DREAMS BECOME REALITY
I WILL TELL YOU OF OLYMPUS AND YOU WILL TELL ME
IF YOU WANT TO COME ALONG AND SEE WHAT MAY BE

HAVE YOU EVER DESIRED GLORY? HAVE YOU EVER DESIRED POWER?
HAVE YOU EVER YEARNED FOR WEALTH BEYOND YOUR WILDEST DREAMS?
I CAN LEAD YOU TO A DESTINY THAT'LL NEVER SOUR,
WHERE THE FLOWERS OF THE MOUNTAIN BOW DOWN TO YOU
AND NOTHING'S AS IT SEEMS

ATHENA #2
I'M NOT HERE TO TALK DOWN TO YOU
YOU MUST REALISE WHY I'VE COME
AND I KNOW THAT YOUR OLD MOM CAN BE A REAL DRAG
BUT I CAN MAKE YOU INTO SOMEBODY
IF YOU DO THIS FAVOUR FOR ME
I'll TELL YOU ONCE BUT I WON'T STICK AROUND AND NAG

WILL YOU COME TO THE LAND WHERE YOUR LIFE CAN BE EASY?
I CAN GIVE YOU A FORGE AND WORKSHOP LAVISH AND VAST
I CAN GIVE YOU THE WORLD IF YOU GIVE ME WHAT I ASK
WILL YOU COME TO YOUR FUTURE?
OR STAY IN YOUR PAST?

HEPHAESTUS
THERE IS NO MOTHER OR FUTURE FOR ME
TAKE ALL OF YOUR GLORY, AND PLEASE LET ME BE

I KNOW IT WOULDN'T BE TOUGH
YOU'RE SO GOOD AT THIS STUFF
AND WOULDN'T MY LOVE BE ENOUGH?
(HEPHAESTUS *returns to his forge and turns his back on* APHRODITE. *She continues to saunter around him, gently touching his arms and trying to engage him to no avail.*)

(APHRODITE #2)
OH, COME ON HONEY,
WON'T YOU THINK TWICE?
YOU KNOW, I CAN BE NASTY
OR I CAN BE VERY NICE
AND AREN'T MY LIPS SWEET CONSOLATION
FOR A SMALL SACRIFICE?
ARE MY WORDS NOT ALLURING?
DOES MY **SWEET FACE** NOT ENTICE?

(HEPHAESTUS *continues to ignore* APHRODITE. *He begins working at his forge.* APHRODITE gets visibly more and more angry.*)*

ALRIGHT, FINE!
YOU'RE NOT ENOUGH TO BE MINE ANYWAY
SO LET ME GO!
I SAID THE ANSWER IS NO!
IT'S YOUR LOSS ANYHOW
SO ADIEU, BOY, AND CIAO!
I WON'T BE SEEING YOU AROUND!

(APHRODITE and the THREE CHARITES exit, and HEPHAESTUS gets back to his work. For a moment there is calm. A whoosh of wind is heard as if an owl is flying down. Flapping wing sounds then a trumpet salutes. ATHENA enters and sizes HEPHAESTUS up.)

DIONYSUS
When Aphrodite missed the mark, though Hera was appalled,
She thought things through and thought it best Athena, the wise, was called
He toiled and he toiled deep into the night
And he had his revenge with the morning light

(*HEPHAESTUS, finishes hammering at his forge and stills, admiring his work.*)

ADULT HEPHAESTUS #3
THE YEARS FLEW BY, MY DAYS GREW LONG
I KEPT MY HANDS BUSY AND I MADE MY HEART STRONG
I KNOW THAT I AM ALL THAT I'VE GOT
NO NEED TO CRY OR MOAN

COMPANY
AND SOON YOU'LL KNOW, YOU'LL RUE THE DAY
YOU THREW HIM IN THE TRASH AND WENT ON YOUR MERRY WAY
YOU ONLY CARE ABOUT YOUR GILDED THRONE
THAT YOU WON IN THE WARS YOU HAVE WAGED
ADULT HEPHAESTUS #3
LET THIS THRONE BE YOUR NEW CAGE

(The Charites – AGLAIA, THALIA, and EUPHROSYNE – enter)

DIONYSUS
Though Hephaestus felt all alone,
His childhood friends, the three Charites, stayed near
Three goddesses of beauty, grace, joy, and charm
Who brought with them community, light, and cheer.
Their names were:

AGLAIA
And Aglaia…

EUPHROSYNE
Euphrosyne…

THALIA
Thalia…

DIONYSUS

They tried to warn Hephaestus not to fall into his pain
They tried to tell him there was so much more
But Hephaestus couldn't quite hear them,
For his heart and mind were both at war

(All 12 thrones are put in place on the mountain as the Three Charites sing)

#4 Hephaestus Steals into the Night

AGLAIA (With THALIA & EUPHROSYNE)

HE WALKED ALL NIGHT
THROUGH THE STILL AND THE COLD
STONE AND METAL ON HIS SHOULDERS
HUGE AND HEAVY TO BEHOLD
AS UNTOLD TRUTHS ABOUT HIS PAST
FLOODED THROUGH HIS MEMORY BUT WOULD NEVER LAST

EUPHROSYNE (With AGLAIA & THALIA)

REVENGE SCREAMED,
BITTER THROUGH THE DARK
AGAINST THE ACHING AND CONFUSION
IN HIS TIRED, ELATED HEART
AND HE PUT ALL OF THAT SADNESS
AND ALL OF THAT RAGE
INTO BEAUTIFUL ART
MADE ONLY TO CONCEAL A CAGE

THALIA (With AGLAIA & EUPHROSYNE)

DO YOU THINK THAT YOU'LL BE HAPPY NOW, ONCE YOU'VE PUT HER THROUGH
THE SAME PAIN AS YOU?
WILL IT BRING YOU JOY TO SEE HER SAD AND STUCK?
WILL IT EVER BE ENOUGH? WILL IT BRING YOU JOY?

SCENE 4

HEPHAESTUS' UNDERWATER VOLCANIC CAVE

(HEPHAESTUS works with his hammer as APHRODITE Enters with the THREE CHARITES, who cover her with large feather fans that unfold to make a shell shape around her, reminiscent of Botticelli's birth of Venus.

(Enter APHRODITE with the THREE CHARITES)

#7 Pretty Things

APHRODITE #1 (On the Mountain)

OH, HI THERE SUGAR,
ARE YOU MAKING PRETTY THINGS?
I HEAR YOU'RE QUITE THE HANDY-MAN
YOU KNOW IT MAKES MY HEART SING
TO SEE YOU WORKING SO HARD
YOU SHOULD BE TREATED LIKE A KING

APHRODITE #2

IF WE PUT OUR HEADS TOGETHER
HOW OUR HEARTS COULD GROW WINGS
AND FLY UP BEYOND THE SKY
NO LIE, IT CAN BE FUN
WHEN TWO BECOME ONE
COME HERE, HOLD ME CLOSE
AND I DON'T MEAN TO BOAST
BUT I COULD MAKE YOU FEEL GRAND

SO SUGAR, WHY NOT TAKE MY PRETTY HAND
WE COULD FROLIC IN THE GLOAMING,
RUN AROUND ON SUN-SOAKED SAND
AND IF YOU STICK WITH ME, HONEY
LIFE COULD BE SWEETER THAN YOU PLANNED
THERE'S JUST ONE TINY LITTLE ISSUE
BEFORE YOU FORGE THE WEDDING BAND

YOUR MOM, SHE'S BEEN FEELING REALLY GLUM
AND YOU'D HAVE TO SET HER FREE
BEFORE YOU COULD HAVE ME

OLYMPIANS
BUT I'M SURE WE'LL FIND A SILVER LINING
AND THAT WE'LL GET YOU ROUND THIS BEND IN TIME
YES, I'M SURE WE'LL FIND A SILVER LINING
AND THAT WE'LL GET YOU ROUND THIS BEND IN TIME

(ZEUS *exits with a bigger flourish, a brighter flash of light, and a peal of thunder.*)

HERA #2
Stop this absurd dawdling at once and get me out of here!
I don't care how you do it – do it now! Scram! Disappear!

(*All of the gods except HERA exit. DIONYSUS approaches her)*

DIONYSUS
I've been around the earth and back, and now I have some thoughts
On whom it might have been who got you all cooped up and cramped and caught…

(DIONYSUS leans in to confer with HERA, who listens attentively.)

(DIONYSUS)
And so, I told Hera everything, to move the plot along
What can I say, as God of Theatre, I've got to keep the tension building strong

So, Hera sent her forces down to make Hephaestus see
That it was in his interest to set his mother free

First, she sent Aphrodite, the beautiful and charmed
Hoping that her way with men would leave Hephaestus disarmed…

SCENE 3

A FLOWERING GROVE ON OLYMPUS
#5 Gifts to the Goddesses

HELIOS #1 & HELIOS #2 & HELIOS #3

THIS MORNING AS I ROSE ABOVE THE ARCH OF EARTH AND SKY
AND MADE MY WAY TO LIGHT THE HEAVENS ALL DAZZLING AND DIVINE
I SPOTTED GOLDEN THRONES FOR ALL THE GODDESSES, MOST GRAND
THAT GLINTED IN THE GLORY OF MY VISAGE, WHERE THE LAND
OF THE GODS KISSES THE CROSSROADS OF ALL THOSE WHO DWELL BELOW
THEY SHONE ALMOST AS BRIGHT AS ME, SO I SIMPLY HAD TO KNOW
WHO SUCH GIFTS WERE MEANT FOR, IN THE EARLY DANCING DAWN…

APOLLO #1
On each throne, an intricate inscription makes their rightful owners clear
One for Aphrodite, one for Artemis over here

ARTEMIS
And every throne is lovely,
Each more lovely that the last

HESTIA
But the most beautiful and glorious of all was cast
From the most precious metals I have ever seen

DEMETER
Moulded into such ornate designs
Fit only for our queen!

HERMES *(Reading a scroll)*
"To the illustrious, the beautiful, the powerful, fair, and fine
Mistress Hera, who sits above us all,
Please accept this token, though it's small,
For one so mighty, proud, and tall…"

HERA #1
Where is my present? Show it now to me at once!

HERA #2
Finally, some appreciation from this sad, ungrateful bunch
I do so much for all of you, it's nice to just be seen
And to be honoured and adored is my birthright as your queen!

(HERA #1 sits in a beautiful, ornate golden chair contentedly. Suddenly a screeching metal sound is heard. Golden chains fly out of the chair around her waist, wrists, and feet. She is trapped. The other gods are obviously amused and begin laughing. She shoots them a deadly glare and they try to hide their amusement.)

#6 Silver Lining

HERA #2
(To ZEUS)
HOW'D YOU LET THIS HAPPEN TO ME?
(To ATHENA)
I THOUGHT THAT YOU WERE SMART!
(To ARES)
WHY DIDN'T YOU SEE THIS COMING?
(To APHRODITE)
DON'T YOU UNDERSTAND MATTERS OF THE HEART?

WHY DO TERRIBLE INJUSTICES ALWAYS COME TO THOSE,
WHO HAVE NEVER DONE ANYTHING WRONG?
(To APHRODITE)
IF I HEAR YOU LAUGH AGAIN, MY DEAR
I'LL SEE TO IT THAT YOUR VOCAL CORDS ARE GONE!

ZEUS #2
WELL, MAYBE THERE'S A SILVER LINING
TO THIS UNIMAGINABLY TRAGIC TURN
AND MAYBE THERE'S A SILVER LINING
AND MAYBE EVEN SOMETHING WE CAN LEARN

(*ZEUS glances at a large sundial on his wrist.*)

OH DEAR, I'M RUNNING LATE FOR AN IMPORTANT MEETING
WITH A LOVELY YOUNG LADY FROM CRETE
BUT I'M SURE WE'LL FIND A SILVER LINING
AND THAT WE'LL GET YOU BACK ON YOUR FEET!

(ZEUS exits with a flourish and a flash of light.)

HERA #2
HOW ARE YOU GOING TO GET ME OUT OF THIS?
DON'T YOU KNOW YOU OWE EVERYTHING TO ME?
IF YOU DON'T GET ME OUT OF THIS, I'LL RUIN YOU – YOU'LL NEVER BE FREE

WHY DO TERRIBLE INJUSTICES COME TO THOSE
WHO HAVE NEVER DONE ANYTHING BAD
(*To POSEIDON*)
IF I SEE YOU MAKE THAT FACE AGAIN
I'LL DESTROY EVERYTHING THAT YOU'VE EVER HAD!
(*ZEUS re-enters, hair and clothing dishevelled and lipstick marks across his face. He rouses the other gods into another chorus.*)

OLYMPIANS
WELL, MAYBE THERE'S A SILVER LINING

APOLLO #1
TO THIS UNIMAGINABLY TRAGIC TURN

OLYMPIANS
AND MAYBE THERE'S A SILVER LINING

APOLLO #1
MAYBE EVEN SOMETHING WE CAN LEARN

ZEUS #2
TOO BAD, I'M SO LATE FOR AN IMPORTANT MEETING
WITH A GORGEOUS SEA NYMPH FRIEND OF MINE